

MTG Creator Ecosystem Platform

Analysis, Positioning, and Product Roadmap

Executive Summary

The idea is not strongest as “another social platform for Magic: The Gathering creators.”

The stronger opportunity is:

Building the discovery and infrastructure layer for the MTG creator ecosystem.

The current MTG ecosystem is highly fragmented across:

- YouTube
- Twitch
- TikTok
- Discord
- Patreon
- Bluesky/X
- Deckbuilding sites
- Podcasts
- Local game stores
- Event organizers
- Tournament circuits

There is no universally adopted platform that:

- helps fans discover creators effectively,
- aggregates creator identity and content,
- connects creators with events and stores,
- or provides business infrastructure for creators.

This creates an opportunity for a platform that combines:

- creator discovery,
- creator profiles,
- cross-platform aggregation,
- event integration,
- local community discovery,
- sponsorship/booking tools,
- and analytics.

The platform should evolve toward:

“IMDb + LinkedIn + Bandsintown for MTG creators.”

Not:

“Another social media platform.”

That distinction is critical.

Existing Products and Market Landscape

Existing Partial Solutions

There are related products and fragmented solutions in the space:

Creator Directories

- Bluesky starter packs
- Linktree pages
- Community-maintained creator lists

Community Platforms

- Girudo
- Discord communities
- Reddit communities

Individual Creator Hubs

- Personal websites
- Patreon pages
- Creator landing pages

MTG Aggregators

- Deck-focused websites
- Tournament result aggregators
- Podcast directories

However, none of these fully solve:

1. Cross-platform creator discovery
2. Centralized creator identity
3. Local scene integration
4. Sponsorship and booking infrastructure

5. Event and appearance tracking
6. Unified creator analytics and visibility

This leaves room for a focused platform.

Core Strategic Insight

The most important realization:

Fans are the audience.

Creators, stores, and organizers are the customers.

Fans create traffic and engagement.

But monetization will likely come from:

- creators,
- local game stores,
- conventions,
- event organizers,
- sponsors,
- and brands.

This should heavily influence product decisions.

The Best Version of the Product

Core Concept

A searchable, structured ecosystem of:

- creators,
- events,
- stores,
- and communities.

Users should be able to:

- discover creators by niche and style,
- follow events and appearances,
- explore local scenes,
- and connect with the broader MTG ecosystem.

High-Value Features

1. Advanced Creator Discovery

This is the foundation of the platform.

Instead of generic creator pages, profiles should include structured metadata.

Example Fields

MTG Formats

- Commander / EDH
- cEDH
- Standard
- Modern
- Legacy
- Pauper
- Limited
- Cube
- Pioneer
- Draft
- Sealed

Content Types

- Gameplay
- Deck Techs
- Lore
- Finance
- Comedy
- Educational
- Tournament Coverage
- Brewing
- Product Reviews
- Collection Content

Audience Style

- Beginner-friendly
- Competitive
- Casual
- High-power
- Budget-focused
- Meme/jank

- Analytical
- Entertainment-first

Additional Metadata

- Upload frequency
- Average video length
- Streaming schedule
- Location/region
- Convention attendance
- Favorite formats
- Associated decks
- Languages spoken
- Collaboration history

This enables meaningful discovery and recommendation systems.

2. Cross-Platform Aggregation

One of the strongest opportunities.

Creators currently manage:

- YouTube
- Twitch
- TikTok
- Patreon
- Discord
- Bluesky
- X/Twitter
- Moxfield
- Archidekt
- Ko-fi
- Personal websites

The platform can become:

The canonical creator profile.

Potential integrations:

- Latest YouTube uploads
- Twitch live status
- Social feeds
- Decklists
- Tournament results

- Event schedules
- Podcast episodes
- Merchandise links
- Affiliate programs

This creates recurring utility for creators.

3. Event and Convention Layer

A major differentiator.

Examples:

- “Creators attending MagicCon Vegas”
- “Commander creators near Seattle”
- “Find creators attending your LGS event”
- “Book a creator for your RCQ”

Potential event features:

- Appearance tracking
- Convention schedules
- Meet-and-greet pages
- Local event discovery
- Creator signings
- Coverage teams
- Community calendars

This creates network effects and local relevance.

4. Creator Business Tools

Potentially the strongest monetization category.

Possible Tools

Sponsorship & Media Kits

- Auto-generated creator profiles
- Audience statistics
- Engagement summaries
- Downloadable media kits

Analytics

- Aggregated cross-platform metrics
- Growth tracking
- Engagement trends
- Audience demographics

Collaboration Tools

- Creator networking
- Find collaborators
- Shared events
- Co-stream discovery

Booking Infrastructure

- Appearance requests
- Convention inquiries
- Sponsored event requests
- Brand outreach

Profile Automation

- Auto-sync social data
 - Auto-import videos/posts
 - Decklist syncing
 - Event syncing
-

5. Store and Organizer Tools

This may become the fastest path to revenue.

Local game stores constantly struggle with:

- marketing,
- creator outreach,
- community growth,
- and event visibility.

Potential Features

Store Pages

- Event schedules
- Featured creators
- Community hubs

- Tournament calendars

Creator Booking Marketplace

- Invite local creators
- Sponsored appearances
- Event commentators
- Judges/content coverage

Promotion Tools

- Boosted event listings
- Featured creators
- Convention partnerships
- Regional discovery

Analytics

- Attendance tracking
- Engagement reports
- Event visibility metrics

Recommendation Engine Opportunity

This may become the platform's most defensible feature.

Example Recommendations

"If you like X creator..."

"Creators similar to..."

"Best creators for beginner Commander players"

"Underrated Modern creators"

"Competitive cEDH streamers"

Discovery in MTG is surprisingly poor today.

A strong recommendation engine could become a major traffic source.

What NOT to Build

Avoid Building Another Social Network

Avoid:

- algorithmic feeds,
- endless posting systems,
- social engagement wars,
- moderation-heavy content systems,
- and trying to compete with existing platforms.

Instead:

Use existing platforms as the content layer.

Your platform becomes:

- the directory,
- the discovery layer,
- the identity layer,
- the infrastructure layer,
- and the networking layer.

Biggest Challenge

Chicken-and-Egg Problem

Fans want creators. Creators want audiences.

You need an initial wedge.

Recommended Initial Wedge

Option A — Creator Database

Start as:

The definitive searchable MTG creator directory.

Why It Works

- Fast MVP
 - Easy onboarding
 - Searchable utility
 - SEO-friendly
 - Easy to grow incrementally
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Option B — Event Companion Platform

Start with:

- event pages,
- creator attendance,
- local discovery,
- and convention integration.

Why It Works

- Natural network effects
 - High engagement windows
 - Strong local utility
 - Easier partnerships
-

Recommended MVP

Phase 1 MVP Goals

Focus on:

- searchable creator profiles,
- discovery,
- and aggregation.

Do NOT overbuild initially.

MVP Feature List

User Features

Creator Profiles

- Bio
- Social links
- Content categories
- MTG formats
- Creator tags
- Region/location
- Featured content

Discovery

- Search
- Filtering
- Tag browsing
- Similar creators
- Trending creators

Integrations

- YouTube
- Twitch
- Bluesky/X
- Moxfield/Archidekt

Event Support (Basic)

- Upcoming appearances
- Convention participation
- Featured events

Technical Architecture Recommendations

Frontend

Recommended:

- React
- Next.js
- TypeScript
- Tailwind

Why:

- SEO support
 - Good routing
 - Strong ecosystem
 - Scalable architecture
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Backend

Recommended:

- Node.js
- PostgreSQL
- Prisma ORM
- GraphQL or REST

Potential additions later:

- Redis
 - Elasticsearch/OpenSearch
 - Background job queues
-

Authentication

Potential providers:

- Clerk
- Auth0
- Supabase Auth
- Firebase Auth

Start simple.

APIs and Integrations

Potential Integrations

Social Platforms

- YouTube API
- Twitch API

- Bluesky API
- X/Twitter API (possibly avoid initially)
- TikTok (difficult API ecosystem)

MTG Ecosystem APIs

- Scryfall
 - Moxfield
 - Archidekt
 - MTGTop8
 - Melee.gg
-

Suggested Database Entities

Core Tables

Users

Creators

Social Accounts

Events

Stores

Tags

Formats

Decklists

Appearances

Sponsorships

Recommendations

Monetization Strategy

1. Freemium Creator Accounts

Free Tier

- Public profile
- Social links
- Basic discovery

Paid Creator Tier (\$5–25/month)

- Analytics
 - Profile customization
 - Sponsorship tools
 - Media kits
 - Priority placement
 - Automation features
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2. Store/Event SaaS

Store Plans (\$25–200/month)

Potential features:

- Event pages
 - Creator outreach
 - Promotion tools
 - Local visibility
 - Analytics
 - Ticketing integrations
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3. Marketplace Revenue

Potential commission sources:

- Creator bookings
 - Sponsored appearances
 - Affiliate partnerships
 - Convention partnerships
 - Brand sponsorships
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Long-Term Expansion Opportunities

Once established in MTG, the architecture can expand into:

- Pokémon
- Flesh and Blood
- Lorcana
- Yu-Gi-Oh
- One Piece TCG

The overlap between TCG audiences is significant.

However:

Start MTG-only.

Niche-first positioning is the correct strategy.

Suggested Roadmap

Phase 0 — Validation (1–3 Weeks)

Goals

- Validate demand
- Identify creator pain points
- Define MVP

Tasks

- Interview 10–20 creators
- Interview local game stores
- Research event organizers
- Create landing page
- Collect email signups
- Build waitlist
- Mock profile pages

Deliverables

- Initial brand direction
- MVP scope
- Waitlist/community

Phase 1 — MVP (4–8 Weeks)

Goal

Launch a searchable creator platform.

Features

- User auth
- Creator profiles
- Search/filtering
- Tags/categories
- Social links
- Responsive UI
- Basic creator dashboard

Optional

- YouTube API sync
- Twitch status integration
- Event fields

Success Metrics

- 100 creators onboarded
- 1,000 monthly visitors
- Organic creator submissions

Phase 2 — Discovery & Aggregation (1–2 Months)

Goal

Improve utility and retention.

Features

- Auto-import content
- Recommendation engine
- Similar creators
- Trending pages
- Saved creators

- Favorites/follows

Success Metrics

- Returning users
 - Time on site
 - Creator profile traffic
-

Phase 3 — Event Layer (1–2 Months)

Goal

Build network effects.

Features

- Event pages
- Convention tracking
- Creator appearances
- Store profiles
- Local discovery
- Calendar integration

Success Metrics

- Event partnerships
 - Store signups
 - Creator attendance usage
-

Phase 4 — Monetization (1–2 Months)

Goal

Validate revenue streams.

Features

- Paid creator plans
- Media kits
- Analytics dashboard
- Sponsored placement

- Store subscriptions

Success Metrics

- First recurring revenue
 - Paid conversion rate
 - Store adoption
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Phase 5 — Marketplace & Expansion

Goal

Become ecosystem infrastructure.

Features

- Booking marketplace
 - Sponsorship system
 - Brand partnerships
 - Convention integrations
 - Multi-TCG support
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Marketing Strategy

Best Early Channels

Reddit

- MTG subreddits
- Commander communities
- Creator communities

Twitter/Bluesky

- Creator outreach
- Convention hashtags
- Community engagement

Discord

- MTG creator servers
- LGS communities

Conventions

- MagicCon
- CommandFest
- Regional tournaments

Local Stores

- Seattle-area pilot partnerships
 - Event collaborations
-

Important Product Philosophy

The platform should not try to replace:

- YouTube
- Twitch
- TikTok
- Discord

Instead:

It should organize and connect them.

Step-by-Step Execution Plan

This section is intended as a practical execution guide for building the platform from idea to launch.

Step 1 — Define the Exact MVP

Goal

Avoid overbuilding.

Your first version should answer one question:

Can MTG fans successfully discover creators using this platform?

That is the only thing your MVP truly needs to validate.

MVP Features ONLY

Required

- Creator accounts
- Public creator profiles
- Search and filtering
- Tags/categories
- Social links
- Responsive UI

Nice to Have

- YouTube sync
- Twitch live status
- Featured creators
- Simple recommendation logic

Avoid Initially

- Messaging systems
- Feeds/timelines
- Complex social features
- Monetization systems
- Sponsorship systems
- Marketplace features

Keep the scope extremely focused.

Step 2 — Validate Before Building

Goal

Make sure creators actually want this.

Actions

Reach Out to Creators

Contact:

- small MTG YouTubers,
- Twitch streamers,
- TikTok creators,

- podcasters,
- local community personalities.

Ask:

- How do fans currently discover you?
- What tools do you wish existed?
- What sucks about current platforms?
- Would you want a centralized creator page?
- Would you maintain/update it?

Target:

- 10–20 conversations.
-

Create a Waitlist Landing Page

Simple page with:

- project description,
- mock screenshots,
- creator signup form,
- fan signup form.

Use:

- Framer,
- Webflow,
- or simple Next.js static page.

Goal:

- measure interest before building.
-

Step 3 — Choose Your Stack

Recommended Stack

Frontend

- Next.js
- React
- TypeScript
- Tailwind CSS

Backend

- Node.js
- PostgreSQL
- Prisma ORM

Hosting

- Vercel (frontend)
- Railway / Supabase / Render / Fly.io (backend/database)

Auth

- Clerk
- Supabase Auth
- or Auth.js

This stack is modern, scalable, and fast for solo development.

Step 4 — Design the Data Model

Before coding UI, define the database structure.

Initial Core Models

User

- id
- email
- username
- role

CreatorProfile

- displayName
- slug
- bio
- avatar
- bannerImage
- location
- website

CreatorTag

- gameplay

- lore
- finance
- comedy
- etc.

MTGFormat

- EDH
- Modern
- Limited
- cEDH
- etc.

SocialLink

- platform
- url
- followerCount

FeaturedContent

- title
- thumbnail
- url
- platform

Important

Build for structured metadata.

This is what powers:

- discovery,
 - recommendations,
 - filtering,
 - SEO,
 - and analytics.
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Step 5 — Build the UI Skeleton

Pages to Create First

Homepage

Include:

- featured creators,
- search bar,
- category browsing,
- trending tags.

Creator Profile Page

Include:

- profile image,
- bio,
- links,
- content categories,
- embedded content,
- MTG formats.

Search/Discovery Page

Include filters:

- format,
- content type,
- platform,
- region,
- creator size.

Creator Dashboard

Allow creators to:

- edit profile,
 - add links,
 - manage tags,
 - upload banners.
-

Step 6 — Implement Authentication

Goal

Allow creators to claim and manage profiles.

Recommended:

- email auth first,
- social auth later.

Keep onboarding simple.

Step 7 — Build Search and Filtering

This is the MOST IMPORTANT feature.

Start Simple

Use:

- PostgreSQL full-text search
- Prisma filtering

You do NOT need Elasticsearch immediately.

Initial Filters

Formats

- Commander
- Modern
- Draft
- Legacy

Content Types

- Gameplay
- Deck Techs
- Finance
- Comedy

Platforms

- YouTube
- Twitch
- TikTok

Audience Style

- Beginner-friendly
 - Competitive
 - Casual
 - Budget
-

Step 8 — Add Integrations

Recommended First Integration

YouTube API

Why:

- easiest user value,
- visible immediately,
- strong creator appeal.

Features:

- latest videos,
 - subscriber count,
 - thumbnails,
 - upload frequency.
-

Then Add

- Twitch status
- Bluesky profiles
- Moxfield decklists

Avoid over-integrating early.

Step 9 — Seed the Platform Yourself

This is critical.

Do NOT wait for creators to populate everything.

Manually Add Initial Profiles

Seed:

- 100–500 creators.

Even partial profiles are fine.

Include:

- top creators,
- mid-sized creators,
- niche creators,
- regional creators.

This makes the site immediately useful.

Step 10 — Launch Softly

Do NOT Do a Huge Launch

Instead:

- onboard creators gradually,
 - gather feedback,
 - improve discovery,
 - iterate quickly.
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Best Initial Communities

Reddit

- r/magicTCG
- r/EDH
- format-specific communities

Discord

- MTG creator communities
- local MTG servers

Bluesky/X

- creator outreach
- event hashtags

Local Game Stores

Especially in Seattle.

Step 11 — Improve Discovery Algorithms

Once users exist, discovery becomes the product.

Build Recommendation Logic

Examples:

- “Creators similar to...”
 - “Fans of X also follow...”
 - “Underrated creators”
 - “Trending this week”
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Recommendation Inputs

Use:

- shared tags,
 - shared audiences,
 - platform overlap,
 - co-following,
 - content similarity.
-

Step 12 — Add Event Features

Once creator discovery works, expand into events.

Initial Event Features

Creator Appearances

- conventions
- CommandFests
- RCQs
- local tournaments.

Event Pages

- participating creators,
- schedules,
- featured content.

Local Discovery

- creators near users,
- nearby events,
- local stores.

Step 13 — Add Creator Tools

Only after discovery is validated.

Potential Tools

Media Kits

Automatically generated.

Analytics

Cross-platform stats.

Booking Requests

For stores/events.

Sponsorship Marketplace

Long-term opportunity.

Step 14 — Monetize Carefully

Do NOT monetize too early.

First:

- create utility,
- create habit,
- create visibility.

Then monetize.

Best First Monetization

Premium Creator Profiles

Potential features:

- enhanced layouts,
- analytics,
- auto-syncing,
- priority search placement.

Store/Event Pages

Subscription model.

Step 15 — Build SEO Early

SEO could become your biggest acquisition channel.

Important SEO Pages

Creator Pages

“Best EDH Creators”

Tag Pages

“Modern Gameplay Creators”

Event Pages

"MagicCon Vegas Creators"

Regional Pages

"Seattle MTG Creators"

Step 16 — Track Metrics

Key Metrics

Supply Side

- creator signups,
- profile completion,
- active creators.

Demand Side

- monthly visitors,
- repeat visitors,
- search usage,
- profile views.

Marketplace Metrics

Eventually:

- bookings,
 - sponsorships,
 - event inquiries.
-

Step 17 — Avoid Common Mistakes

Biggest Risks

1. Overbuilding

Ship smaller and faster.

2. Becoming a Social Network

Avoid feeds and moderation nightmares.

3. Too Many Features Too Early

Discovery is the core product.

4. Ignoring Mobile UX

A huge percentage of users will browse on mobile.

5. Weak Creator Onboarding

Make profile setup extremely fast.

Suggested Build Timeline

Month 1

- validation,
- wireframes,
- landing page,
- creator interviews.

Month 2

- auth,
- creator profiles,
- database,
- search.

Month 3

- integrations,
- profile polish,
- seed creator data.

Month 4

- beta launch,
- creator onboarding,
- feedback loops.

Month 5–6

- recommendations,
 - events,
 - store partnerships.
-

Recommended Immediate Next Actions

This Week

1. Buy the Domain

Pick a strong brandable name.

2. Create Wireframes

Use:

- Figma,
- Excalidraw,
- or even paper.

3. Build Landing Page

Collect emails.

4. Talk to Creators

This is the highest-value activity right now.

5. Define the MVP

Write down EXACTLY what version 1 includes.

Final Strategic Positioning

The strongest framing is:

A discovery and infrastructure platform for the MTG creator ecosystem.

Not:

A social network.

If executed well, this could become:

- the default creator directory,
- the networking layer,
- the event discovery layer,
- and eventually the business infrastructure layer for MTG creators and communities.

That positioning is substantially more defensible and monetizable than a pure fan social platform.